

ear-passages are stopped by the tumour in the form of unbridled arrogance, do not listen to what is said to them by way of advice. And, even when they listen, as they treat it with contempt in the manner of an elephant closing his eyes (and remaining indifferent to all that passes around), they pain their teachers who offer them beneficial advice. The kingly nature is always perturbed, being darkened by the swoon caused by the burning fever of self-conceit; riches produce the delirium in the form of false pride; and regal glory induces a coma brought on by the working of the poison of kingly power.

Let your honour, ever bent on doing what is good, consider (i.e. examine) Lakshmi (Goddess of wealth) herself first. This Lakshmi, who is (as it were) the bee sportively moving about in the lotus-bed of the circle of the swords of brave warriors, (first) arose from the Milky Ocean, bringing with her these mementos to lighten (the pangs of) separation, on account of her fondness for them due to (long) residence together; viz. (she brought) *rāga* (passion) from the leaves of the Pārijāta tree (which possess *ragā*—redness); extreme *vākratā* (perverseness) from the crescent-moon (which possesses *vākratā*—curvedness); *chanchalatā* (unsteadiness) from (the horse) Uchchaiṣravas (who possesses *chanchalatā*—fleetness); the power of *mohana* (infatuating) from (the deadly poison) Kālakūṭa (which possesses the power of *mohana*—causing swoon); *mada* (arrogance) from wine (which possesses *mada*—drunkenness); and extreme *naishikūrya* (cruelty) from the Kaustubha gem (which possesses *naishikūrya*—hardness). There is nothing else in this world which is so regardless of (the tie of) familiarity (i.e. friendship) as this wicked dame (Lakshmi). (For) even when obtained, she is retained with great difficulty. Though made fast (secure) by being tied with the ropes of merits, she vanishes. Even when held fast (confined) within the cage (i.e. cage-like array) of the thin, long swords brandished (wielded) by thousands of extremely proud (very heroic) warriors, she escapes. Though guarded all round by the dense columns of elephants darkened with the showers of their rut-water, she slips away. She cares not for (the tie of) familiarity; regards not noble birth; looks not to beauty; has no respect for hereditary connexion; looks not on character or virtue; counts (minds) not cleverness (culture); has no ear for learning; regards not righteousness; honours not munificence; takes no heed of disreputation (one's power to distinguish merit from demerit);

observes not customary duties; takes no account of truth; and she sets no value upon (a person's possessing) auspicious marks. Like the outline of the city of the Gandharvas! she vanishes just as one is looking at her. She wanders about (i.e. from person to person) as though she is still under the influence of the giddy sensation caused by her being whirled round in the whirl-pool made by the turnings of the Mandara mountain. She nowhere plants her foot firmly, as though a thorn in a lotus-stalk were run into it on account of her roamings in lotus-beds. Even when held firmly with very great efforts, in the palaces of great kings, she reels aside, (goes away) as if intoxicated by drinking wine (i.e. ichor) from the temples of numerous scent-elephants. She dwells (i.e., depends for stability) on the edges of swords, as if to learn *pārushya* (cruelty) from them which possess *pārushya*—keenness). She clings to (the chest-region of) the body of Nārāyaṇa, as if to learn *visvarūpa* (presenting all kinds of illusory appearances) from him, who possesses *visvarūpa*—the state of having the whole universe contained in his form). Full of apprehension (*lit.*, having no confidence for the most part in one), she leaves a king, even though he may have well enriched (made good additions) to his inherited territory, his army, his treasury, and the number of princes subordinate unto him, as she does a lotus at the close of the day although it may have a well developed root, stalk and its circular pericarp. Like a creeper which climbs branches of trees, she dwells with persons who patronize parasites (voluptuous persons). Like Gaṅgā who although she gave birth to the (eight) Vasus is restless with her ripples and bubbles, she, although the producer of wealth, is yet as fickle as the bubbles of waves. Like the movement of the sun which exhibits the various stages of his passage from one zodiacal sign to another, she exhibits her own fitting movements (from one person to another). Like a cave of the Nether Regions which is full of darkness, she is full of dark deeds. Like (the demoness) Hīḍimbā whose heart was captivated solely by the daring deeds of Bhīma, she is one whose heart can be attracted only by deeds of stupendous daring. Like the rainy season which produces lightning, she produces a short-lived glow (display of prosperity). Like a wicked she-goblin who

¹ The phantom of a city in the sky due to some meteorological cause, called.

As if made of dust she soils even the pure.¹ And the more this fickle one blazes forth (makes a man more and more prosperous) the more does she give rise to actions, dark like lampblack, alone, just as the more the flickering flame of a lamp burns, the more does it produce black soot, (and nothing else). It is thus:—She acts as the nourishing stream of water to the poisonous creepers in the form of (evil) desires; as the song of a hunter to (for luring away) the deer in the form of the senses; as the obscuring line of smoke to the pictures in the form of good actions; as a luxurious bed to the long sleep of infatuation; as an old terrace for residence to the she-goblins in the form of pride of wealth; as the appearance of *timira* (opacity of the cornea) to the eyes in the form of the *Ś s ras*; as the banner borne in the van to all deeds of insolence; as the native river to the alligators in the form of the out-bursts of violence; as the drinking ground to the wines in the form of pleasures; as the music-hall to the gestures in the form of the knittings of the eye-brows; as the residence-cavern (lair) to the pythons in the form of faults; as the cane-staff (for driving away people), to the words (of advice) of good men; as the untimely (setting in of the) rains, to the swans in the form of merits; as the (favourable) surface for spreading, to the tumours in the form of public scandals; as the prologue, to the drama in the form of deception; as the banner to (on the head of) the elephant in the form of lust; as the slaughter-house, to good intentions; and as the (eclipsing) tongue of Rāhu to the orb of the moon in the form of righteousness. And I do not see anyone who has not been (suddenly) very closely embraced by her though not familiar with him, and then deceived. Surely she will move away (*i.e.*, leave a person), even when consigned to a picture (*i.e.*, visualized mentally as sure of attainment); will produce illusions like magic, even when confined to books (*i.e.*, made as steady as matter committed to books); she will deceive, even when (merely) engraved as a statue (in one's mind, *i.e.*, when means be conceived to remove short-comings and make her steady); will cheat, even when (merely) heard of; and will take one in, even when (merely) thought about (leads men to seek her but they find her not).

And when in obedience to the will of destiny, kings are somehow favoured by her, who is of this description and behaves so

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(equal to) that of several men drives a timid man into frenzy. (rise to prosperity) of many weak-minded person (or, makes him of jealousy, she embraces not a *asvatī* (the goddess of learning). i., as if he were unholy. She does and person, as if he were something (en) look at a good man, as at an voids) a high-born person, like a on, as if he were a thorn (in her forgets to approach) a liberal man, She approaches not an educated he mocks at a noble-minded person, in this world she manifests her ; a juggler's tricks which (on their other. For example:—Though cold.¹ Though bestowing height h sprung from the store of water, e transforms one into Śiva, still ot of Śiva.⁴ Though she increases on lightness (loss of weight).⁵ from the same place as) nectar rise to a bitter taste.⁶ Though ual sight is invisible to the senses. still she loves wicked persons.³ a man in good spirits, and yet makes elevation of rank or position, and yet the Ocean, and she increases one's n wealthy, and leads to vileness of a highly powerful, and makes him sters in her train'. (sters) strife'. अश्रयस्सुदर्शना may mean a long for things not actually within to Viṣṇu, and she loves (favours)

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